

Fire and Ice by Robert Frost

❖Summary❖

In this poem, Frost talks about how the world will end. Some say by fire, some say by ice. He connects Fire with Desire and Ice with Hatred. He says he has experienced desire, so he knows fire can destroy the world. Then he says hatred is also very powerful. If the world has to end twice, ice (hatred) is also enough to destroy it. Moral: Both uncontrolled desire and hatred can destroy humanity. We should control our emotions.

❖সাৰাংশ❖

এই কবিতাটোত ফ্ৰষ্টে পৃথিৱীখন কেনেকৈ শেষ হ'ব সেই বিষয়ে কৈছে। কোনোৱে কয় জুইৰ দ্বাৰা, কোনোবাই কয় বৰফৰ দ্বাৰা। তেওঁ অগ্নিক ইচ্ছাৰ সৈতে আৰু বৰফক ঘৃণাৰ সৈতে সংযোগ কৰে। তেওঁ কয় যে তেওঁ ইচ্ছাৰ অভিজ্ঞতা লাভ কৰিছে, গতিকে তেওঁ জানে জুইয়ে পৃথিৱীখন ধ্বংস কৰিব পাৰে। তাৰ পিছত তেওঁ কয় ঘৃণাও অতি শক্তিশালী। যদি পৃথিৱীখন দুবাৰকৈ শেষ হ'ব লগা হয়, তেন্তে ইয়াক ধ্বংস কৰিবলৈ বৰফ (ঘৃণা)ও যথেষ্ট।

নৈতিকতাঃ অনিয়ন্ত্রিত কামনা আৰু ঘৃণা দুয়োটাই মানৱতাক ধ্বংস কৰিব পাৰে। আমি আমাৰ আৱেগক নিয়ন্ত্ৰণ কৰা উচিত।

word-meanings from Fire and Ice:

1. Some say – People believe
 2. Favour – Support
 3. Fire – Desire, greed, lust
 4. Ice – Hatred, coldness, indifference
 5. Perish – Die, get destroyed
 6. Destruction – The act of destroying
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□ Important Q&A of Fire and Ice – Robert Frost □

1. What do fire and ice symbolize in the poem?

Ans: Fire symbolizes desire, greed, and lust. Ice symbolizes hatred, coldness, and indifference.

2. What is the poet's opinion about the end of the world?

Ans: The poet thinks the world can end either by fire or by ice. Both are powerful enough for destruction.

3. Why does the poet hold with those who favour fire?

Ans: Because from what he has tasted of desire, he knows desire is very strong and can cause destruction like fire.

4. What does the poet know enough of hate? Why does he mention it?

Ans: The poet has experienced hatred. He says hatred has the same destructive power as desire. Ice can also end the world.

5. What is the central idea / message of the poem?

Ans: Human emotions like unchecked desire and hatred can destroy the world. We should control them and live with love.

6. How is the poem relevant to present day?

Ans: Today there is a lot of greed, intolerance and hatred. Wars, conflicts happen due to desire and hate. So the poem warns us that these feelings can lead to the end of humanity.



Thinking about the Poem



1. There are many ideas about how the world will end. Do you think the world will end some day? Have you ever thought what would happen if the sun got so hot that it burst, or grew colder and colder?

Ans: Yes, I think the world will end someday. Everything that has a beginning has an end.

If the sun gets too hot and bursts, the whole world will burn with fire. All life will be destroyed by heat.

If the sun gets colder and colder, there will be no light and no heat. Everything will freeze and the world will be covered with ice. Life will end due to extreme cold.

So both fire (heat) and ice (cold) can cause the end of the world.

2. For Frost, what do 'fire' and 'ice' stand for?

Here are some ideas:

Greed, conflict, insensitivity, avarice, fury
coldness, cruelty, intolerance, indifference, lust,
rigidity, hatred.

Ans: Fire stands for: greed, avarice, fury, lust,
conflict, intolerance, cruelty

Ice stands for: hatred, coldness, insensitivity, indifference, rigidity

3. What is the rhyme scheme of the poem? How does it help in bringing out the contrasting ideas in the poem?

Ans: Rhyme scheme of Fire and Ice is – aba abc bcb.

Fire – ice – desire

Favour – fire – twice

Hate – great – ice

How it helps:

The interlinked rhyme scheme connects the ideas tightly. The first part (aba) links fire, ice and desire together showing both views about end. The second part (abc) connects favour, fire and hate showing poet's personal experience. The

last part (bcb) connects hate, great and ice to conclude that both fire and ice are equally destructive. The short, sharp rhymes make the contrast between fire and ice more striking and memorable.
